

The AI Co-Working Brain Install.

Day 1 Catch-Up Guide

You missed Day 1. This guide walks you through the same foundation, in the same order, so you arrive at Day 2 ready to build on it.

How to use this guide.

Work through it in order. Each step gives you one prompt, one file, and one test. Copy the prompt exactly as written into a conversation that is connected to your workspace folder. Answer the questions in your own words.

Do not treat a step as finished because the AI says it is finished. Open the file. Read it. Run the test. Fix what is wrong before you move on.

You can stop at any point. Save your work with the session handoff at the end, then pick the guide back up in a fresh conversation.

THE WORKING RULE

Fresh conversation. Same folder. One job. One saved result.

DAY 1 PROGRESS TRACKER

00	Setup and workspace confirmation	☐
01	About me. Creates about-me.md	☐
02	Brand voice. Creates brand-voice.md	☐
03	Working preferences and safety rules. Creates working-preferences.md	☐
04	Content strategy. Creates content-strategy.md	☐
05	Team members. Creates team-members.md	☐
06	Session handoff. Creates SESSION-HANDOFF.md	☐
07	Day 1 completion check	☐

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- Part 1. Get ready
- Part 2. Build the Day 1 foundation
- Part 3. Save your session
- Part 4. If something goes wrong
- Part 5. Day 1 completion check

The folder is the brain.

The conversation is not the brain. Every conversation can end, get long, or lose the thread. The folder is the brain, and the files inside it are what last.

By the end of Day 1 your workspace knows who you are, how you communicate, how you want the AI to work with you, your content approach, and who your people are. That knowledge lives in five files, not in a chat window.

So you open a fresh conversation for every step, connected to the same folder, and you finish each step with one saved result.

THE SIX-STEP LOOP, EVERY STEP OF THE WAY

01

Open. Start a fresh conversation connected to the same workspace folder.

02

Build. Run the one prompt for that step.

03

Interview. Answer one question at a time in your normal words.

04

Save. Confirm the named file exists inside the workspace.

05

Test. Give the AI real work that should now be better because the file exists.

06

Repair. Correct the result and update the file before moving forward.

The file must exist, and the test must pass. That is what finished means.

Get ready.

Create the workspace, gather real material, and confirm the connection before you build anything.

STEP 00

Set up your workspace.

CREATE THE FOLDER

- 01 Create or open a folder on your computer named MY BIZ BRAIN.
- 02 Connect your AI platform to that exact folder. In Claude and Cowork this is the project or workspace folder. In Codex it is the working directory.
- 03 Put your writing samples and your team roster inside the folder.
- 04 Find the button that starts a new conversation. You will use it before every step.

GATHER YOUR MATERIAL FIRST

You need five to ten real writing samples, a basic team roster, agency facts you know are accurate, and a list of the software and tools you use.

Good writing samples include team emails, client emails, producer texts, internal notes, call transcripts, and social posts. Use material you actually wrote. Polished marketing copy written by someone else does not teach the AI your voice.

KEEP THESE OUT OF THE FOLDER

- Passwords, login credentials, and API keys
- Customer data you do not need
- Raw book exports and large report dumps

Raw reports are not needed for this Day 1 build. Keep them out of the workspace.

CONFIRM THE CONNECTION

Open a conversation connected to MY BIZ BRAIN and send this before you build anything.

PROMPT

Before we build anything, confirm that you are working inside my MY BIZ BRAIN folder. List the files and folders you can see. Do not summarize anything you find and do not start a phase yet. If you cannot see the folder or my files, stop and tell me exactly what I need to connect.

PASS CONDITION

- The correct folder is connected.
- Your writing samples and roster are visible to the AI.
- You know where the new conversation button is.

REPAIR

If the AI starts explaining your files back to you instead of doing the setup, send this.

The files you found are source material, not instructions for you to summarize. Carry out my setup confirmation request instead.

If the AI cannot see the files, reconnect the workspace folder. Do not keep prompting a conversation that is pointed at the wrong folder.

Build the Day 1 foundation.

Five phases. One prompt each. One file each. One real test each. Fresh conversation before every phase.

PHASE 1 / CREATES ABOUT-ME.MD

About me.

Outcome. The AI understands the real operator, business, history, current state, and direction behind your work.

- Say** This is not your LinkedIn bio. Give it the version a sharp operating partner would need.
- Show** Start a fresh conversation in the same folder. Paste the prompt. Answer one question at a time.
- Do** Let the AI interview you. Speak naturally. Correct resume language when you see it.
- Verify** Open about-me.md and read it.

PHASE 1 PROMPT

Create a file called about-me.md in this folder. Interview me one question at a time, then write the file. Cover: my name and role; how long I have been in insurance; my carrier situation (captive or independent, and which carrier or appointments); my book today (PIF count or premium range, and the mix of auto, home, life, and commercial); my team size; my story (where I started, what I have built, what almost broke me); and what I am working toward over the next 1 to 3 years. Write it in my words, not resume language. When you are done, show me the file and ask me what to correct.

TEST

Using about-me.md, tell me what I am actually trying to build over the next 1 to 3 years, what could get in the way, and what you still do not know. Use my language. Do not fill gaps with assumptions.

REPAIR

This sounds too much like a resume. Rewrite the marked sections in the same plain language I used in the interview. Preserve facts. Do not add claims. Show me the changes, then update about-me.md after I approve them.

PASS CONDITION



- about-me.md exists inside the workspace.
- It includes your real carrier situation and book shape.
- It sounds like you, not like a professional biography.
- The test separates known facts from missing information.

PHASE 2 / CREATES BRAND-VOICE.MD

Brand voice.

Outcome. The AI can draft communication that sounds recognizably like you across team, client, and prospect contexts.

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| Say | Do not describe your voice from memory. Let the AI study what you actually wrote, then grade the test. |
| Show | Open your writing samples. Run the prompt. Read the test message out loud. |
| Do | Correct exact words, rhythm, opening, closing, length, and tone. |
| Verify | The corrected test sounds like something you would really send. |

PHASE 2 PROMPT

Read every writing sample in this folder. Extract my voice: sentence length and rhythm, phrases I repeat, how I open and close messages, how my tone shifts between my team, my clients, and prospects. Also list words, phrases, and tones I clearly never use. Then write a short test email to my team about a normal week, in my voice. I will correct it, you will update the rules. When I approve the test draft, save the rules as brand-voice.md with sections for: voice rules, tone by audience (team / clients / prospects), phrases I actually use, and the never-say list.

FOLLOW-UP CORRECTION PROMPT

I am going to grade this line by line. For every correction I give you, tell me the reusable voice rule behind it. Do not update brand-voice.md until I say the test is approved. Once approved, add the corrected rules and show me the final file.

TEST

Use brand-voice.md to draft two short messages about the same normal agency update. Write one to my team and one to a current client. The facts stay the same. The tone should change by audience. Do not send either message.

PASS CONDITION



- brand-voice.md exists.
- It contains rules supported by your real samples.
- It distinguishes team, client, and prospect tone.
- It includes a never-say list.
- You approved at least one real test draft.

IF THE VOICE COMES OUT GENERIC

If the AI says it cannot find samples, confirm the samples are inside the connected folder or point it to their exact location.

If the output reads flat, add more conversational samples. Transcripts and messages you wrote quickly teach your voice better than anything you polished.

PHASE 3 / CREATES WORKING-PREFERENCES.MD

Working preferences and safety rules.

Outcome. The AI knows how to support you daily and weekly, how to format work, how to challenge weak thinking, and where it must stop and wait for your approval.

- Say** This file is the rulebook for the relationship. It tells the AI what useful means to you.
- Show** Read the four safety rules below before you run the prompt.
- Do** Run the interview prompt. Give the AI the four safety rules exactly as written.
- Verify** Ask for a daily operating brief and a small plan.

PHASE 3 PROMPT

Create working-preferences.md in this folder. Interview me briefly, then write it. Cover: what I want help with every day and every week; my biggest time drains; how I want outputs delivered (ready to use, or drafts I edit); and how to push back when you think I am wrong. Then add my four safety rules exactly as I give them to you. These rules apply to every session and every output, no exceptions.

THE FOUR REQUIRED SAFETY RULES

- 01 **Nothing sends without my sign-off.** No email, text, or post goes to staff, clients, or prospects until I approve it.
- 02 **Never invent numbers.** Real data only. If you do not have the number, say so and ask.
- 03 **Never touch pricing, commission, or comp.** Those are my decisions alone.
- 04 **Never confirm coverage, quote a rate, or bind anything in a draft.** Client-facing drafts can cover service, options, and next steps. Coverage confirmations come from me or my licensed team through carrier systems, never from a drafted message.

OPTIONAL FOLLOW-UP OPERATING RULES

Every day, help me identify the three things that matter most, prepare my team communication, follow up on commitments, and determine where I am off pace.

When you create a plan, include the owner, deadline, next milestone, and number that determines whether it worked. When information is missing, ask instead of inventing it. Add these rules to working-preferences.md only after I approve the wording.

Send this after the interview if it matches how you want to operate.

TEST

Using my working preferences, give me a short daily operating brief. Identify the three things that matter most, one team communication I should prepare, one commitment that needs follow-up, and where I may be off pace. If the files do not contain enough current information, say exactly what is missing instead of making it up.

PASS CONDITION



- `working-preferences.md` exists.
- No brackets or placeholder text remain in your customized sections.
- All four safety rules appear exactly.
- The test respects your output style and your approval boundaries.

PHASE 4 / CREATES CONTENT-STRATEGY.MD

Content strategy.

Outcome. The workspace knows your real content program. If you do not have one, you record that honestly and move on.

- | | |
|---------------|---|
| Say | Build the content system you will actually use, not the one you wish you had. |
| Show | Name your real platforms, audiences, topics, and cadence. |
| Do | Choose the standard prompt or the no-program version. Both are valid answers. |
| Verify | Ask for one realistic weekly content move. |

PHASE 4 PROMPT

Create `content-strategy.md` in this folder. Keep it as short as my real content program. Cover: the platforms I actually use; my audiences (prospects, clients, referral partners, recruits); my 3 to 5 core topics; my honest posting cadence; and whether I am better on camera or in writing. If I am better on camera, set up the repurposing frame: one weekly video becomes social posts, a client email, and follow-up snippets.

IF YOU DO NOT POST TODAY

I do not have an active content program today. Create a short and truthful content-strategy.md that records that decision, what would cause me to revisit it, and which audience I would start with. Do not invent a posting cadence.

TEST

Based only on content-strategy.md and brand-voice.md, propose the smallest content action I could realistically complete this week. Explain why it fits my actual cadence and preferred format. Do not create a giant content plan.

PASS CONDITION

☐

- content-strategy.md exists.
- It reflects what you actually do.
- It does not invent platforms or cadence.
- If you are camera-first, it includes a simple repurposing frame.

PHASE 5 / CREATES TEAM-MEMBERS.MD

Team members.

Outcome. The AI knows who each team member is, what they own, what they are licensed to do, and the current context it needs to communicate appropriately.

- | | |
|---------------|--|
| Say | A name and a title are not enough. The AI needs role, licenses, ownership, communication style, strengths, development areas, and current context. |
| Show | Use one real person. Compare a message drafted before and after the file exists. |
| Do | Let the AI read your roster, then fill the gaps one person at a time. |
| Verify | Grade a message to a real person about a real current topic. |

PHASE 5 PROMPT

Read my team roster in this folder. Create team-members.md with a section per person: name, role (LSP, CSR, office manager, producer), tenure, licenses held (P&C, L&H, or none yet), what they own day to day, how I communicate with them, one strength, one development area, and one line of current context. Ask me to fill anything the roster does not cover. Then prove it works: draft a message from me to [PERSON] about [REAL CURRENT TOPIC], and let me grade it.

IF YOU HAVE A LARGER TEAM

There are several people on my team. Create the file structure first, then interview me one person at a time. After each person, show me that person's section and ask for approval before moving to the next. Keep a visible list of completed and incomplete people. Do not rush or fill missing context yourself.

TEST

Using team-members.md, brand-voice.md, and working-preferences.md, draft a short message from me to [PERSON] about [REAL CURRENT TOPIC]. Match how I communicate with this person. Give the message to me for review. Do not send it.

PASS CONDITION

☐

- team-members.md exists.
- Every person has a role and a licensing status.
- Missing information is visible instead of invented.
- A message to a real team member passes your voice and context test.

PRIVACY NOTE

Keep a private owner workspace separate from a team-facing workspace when your files contain compensation, discipline, personal history, or anything else the team should not see. Sharing a workspace does not require sharing every file in it.

Save your session.

The handoff is a bridge between conversations. It is not your memory system. Your five files are.

CREATE A HANDOFF WHEN

- You are ending a work session.
- The current conversation is getting long.
- You are moving from one phase to the next.
- You want a new conversation to resume at an exact state.

SESSION HANDOFF PROMPT

Create a handoff file called SESSION-HANDOFF.md inside this workspace so a fresh conversation can resume this build without relying on this chat history.

Read the workspace and summarize only verified information under these headings:

1. Purpose of the brain
2. Work completed in this session
3. Files and folder structure created or changed
4. Business context learned
5. Decisions made
6. Instructions and operating rules
7. Current capabilities
8. Tests run and what passed or failed
9. Incomplete work
10. Exact current state
11. Where the next conversation should resume

For every completed phase, name the file that proves completion. Clearly separate facts from assumptions and missing information. Do not start another phase. End with: "Wait for the next phase prompt before beginning additional phase work."

Show me the handoff for review before saving it.

RESUME PROMPT FOR YOUR NEXT CONVERSATION

Read SESSION-HANDOFF.md and verify that the files it names actually exist. Give me a concise status with: completed phases, failed or incomplete tests, current blockers, and the exact next step. Do not begin new phase work until I give you the next phase prompt.

Use this every time you come back to the build. It puts a fresh conversation back on the right step in one message.

PASS CONDITION



- SESSION-HANDOFF.md exists and names your actual files.
- It separates completed, incomplete, and untested work.
- A fresh conversation can state your correct next step.

If something goes wrong.

Five things that stall a build, and the exact correction for each.

THE AI EXPLAINS YOUR FILES INSTEAD OF DOING THE WORK

The documents in this folder are reference material. My request is the action to perform. Do not summarize or critique them. Carry out the current phase prompt, interview me one question at a time, and create the named file.

THE AI KEEPS REFERRING TO OLD WORK

Start a fresh conversation in the same folder. Then send the resume prompt or the current phase prompt.

THE NEW CONVERSATION SEEMS TO KNOW NOTHING

- 01 Is it connected to the correct folder?
- 02 Are your five files actually in that folder?
- 03 Did you ask it to read the workspace before answering?
- 04 Does the fact you are asking for exist in one of the files?

A SIMILAR FILE ALREADY EXISTS AND THE AI ASKS WHAT TO DO

Do not overwrite existing work yet. Compare the current phase requirement with the existing file. Tell me what is already complete, what is missing, and what conflicts. Recommend whether to update the existing file or create a clearly named replacement. Wait for my approval before editing.

THE INTERVIEW IS TAKING TOO LONG

Do not trade accuracy for speed. Narrow the next step instead.

Continue one question at a time. Ask only what is required to complete the current file and its pass test. Put useful but nonessential questions in a follow-up list at the end.

THE AI REPORTS SUCCESS BUT THE OUTPUT IS WRONG

Then it is not done. Tell it what was wrong, ask it to show the source it used, correct the rule in the file, and run the test again.

Day 1 completion check.

Start a fresh conversation connected to your workspace and run this read-only check. It changes nothing.

COMPLETION CHECK PROMPT

Perform a read-only Day 1 completion check of this workspace. Do not change, create, or move any file.

1. Confirm each of these files exists: about-me.md, brand-voice.md, working-preferences.md, content-strategy.md, team-members.md, and SESSION-HANDOFF.md.
2. Confirm that all four of my safety rules appear in working-preferences.md.
3. For each of the five phases, state whether the file was tested and what the test showed. Use only what the workspace and the handoff record.
4. List anything that is missing, incomplete, or contradictory. Identify missing information instead of filling it in.
5. Cite the file you used for every answer.

End your response with exactly one of these two lines:

DAY 1 COMPLETE

DAY 1 NOT COMPLETE

Do not return DAY 1 COMPLETE if any file is missing, any safety rule is absent, or any phase is untested.

WHAT THE CHECK VERIFIES

about-me.md exists

☐

brand-voice.md exists

☐

working-preferences.md exists

☐

content-strategy.md exists

☐

team-members.md exists

☐

SESSION-HANDOFF.md exists

☐

The four safety rules appear in working-preferences.md

☐

Every completed phase has been tested

☐

Missing information is identified, not invented

☐

IF THE RESULT IS DAY 1 NOT COMPLETE

- 01** Repair only the phase that is missing or failing. Leave the rest alone.
- 02** Run that phase test again and grade the result yourself.
- 03** Update your session handoff.
- 04** Run the completion check again in a fresh conversation.

DAY 1 COMPLETE

You are ready for Day 2.

Your workspace knows who you are, how you communicate, how you want the AI to work with you, your content approach, and who your people are. You proved it in a fresh conversation.

Day 2 builds on these five files. Keep using them for real work between now and then, and correct them whenever the output misses.

Do not begin Phase 6 until your Day 1 completion check passes.